

**A STUDY ON INFLUENCE OF INSTAGRAM MARKETING ON PURCHASE DECISION OF
GEN Z CUSTOMERS**

A PROJECT

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DECLARATION

We hereby declare that the project entitled ‘**The study on Influence of Instagram marketing of purchase decision on Gen z customer’s** submitted by **Shifa Mariyam (231491601046), Sreekash A V (231491601047), Suchana Rosary R M (231491601048), Suhaib J (231491601049)** to the Department of Commerce, B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science and Technology, Chennai, is our original work. The project has not been previously used for the award of any degree, diploma, associateship, fellowship, or any other similar title from any University or Institutions. The material borrowed from other sources and incorporated in the project has been duly acknowledged. We understand that ourselves could be held responsible and accountable for plagiarism, if any, detected later on.

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Signature of The

Students:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.

CERTIFICATION

This is to certify that the project entitled “**The study on Influence of Instagram marketing of purchase decision on Gen z customers**” submitted by **Shifa Mariyam M(231491601046), Suchana Rosary R M (231491601047), Sreekash A V(231491601048), Suhaib J (231491601049)**, is a Bonafide research work for the partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Commerce at the Department of Commerce, B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science and Technology, Vandalur, Chennai. To the best of our knowledge, the project has not been used previously for the award of any degree, associateship, fellowship, or any other similar title from any University or Institution.

Place:

Date:

Signature of the
project guide

Signature of Head of
the Department

Signature of the External
Examiner

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

INTRODUCTION 1.1

1.1 STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

As social media grows rapidly, Instagram has become a major platform for marketing and promotion. Businesses invest heavily in Instagram marketing strategies like influencer promotions, sponsored ads, and engaging content to attract Gen Z consumers. However, there is uncertainty about how these strategies influence consumers' final purchasing decisions. Many Gen Z users encounter a large amount of promotional content daily, but not all of it leads to actual purchases. Factors like trust, authenticity, peer influence, and personal preferences are crucial in decision-making. Therefore, it is essential to study whether Instagram marketing genuinely affects buying behaviour or just raises awareness and interest. This study will investigate the extent to which Instagram marketing influences Gen Z purchase decisions and examine the key factors driving their buying behaviour.

1.2 NEED OF THE STUDY

The growing use of Instagram among young consumers has made it an essential platform for digital marketing. Businesses count on Instagram to promote products, raise brand awareness, and influence customer decisions. However, it is vital to understand how effective these strategies are at affecting real purchasing behaviour. There is a need to analyse how Gen Z consumers respond to various types of Instagram marketing content, such as influencer recommendations, ads, and reels. This study helps identify the factors that build trust, attract attention, and stimulate purchasing decisions. The results will assist marketers in creating better strategies, help businesses target the right audience, and aid researchers in understanding changing consumer behaviour in the digital age.

1.3 OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY PRIMARY OBJECTIVE

To examine how Instagram marketing influences the purchasing decisions of Generation Z customers.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVES

1. To identify key Instagram marketing factors (like influencer marketing, Instagram ads, reels/stories, and engagement) that shape Gen Z purchase decisions.

2. To analyse the relationship between influencer marketing and Gen Z purchasing choices.
3. To examine the impact of Instagram advertisements (paid promotions and sponsored posts) on Gen Z buying decisions.
4. To assess the satisfaction level of Gen Z customers.
5. To identify the expectations of Gen Z customers from Instagram.

1.4 SCOPE OF THE STUDY

This study focuses on analysing how Instagram marketing influences the purchasing decisions of Generation Z customers. It specifically targets individuals aged 18 to 25 who actively use Instagram and regularly encounter different types of digital marketing content on the platform. The research primarily examines key Instagram marketing elements such as influencer promotions, sponsored ads, reels, stories, and brand-created content. It aims to understand how these features shape consumer awareness, interest, trust, and ultimately, purchasing decisions. The study also considers factors like how often users access Instagram, their level of engagement with content, and their responsiveness to promotional strategies. Geographically, the study is limited to a specific area and is based on responses collected via structured questionnaires. It does not address other social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, or YouTube, focusing solely on Instagram as the primary subject of analysis. Furthermore, the study is limited to understanding consumer behaviour and does not provide an in-depth analysis of business performance or the financial outcomes of marketing strategies. Despite these limitations, the study offers valuable insights into how effective Instagram marketing is at influencing the buying behaviour of Gen Z consumers.

1.5 FEASIBILITY OF THE STUDY

The study is highly feasible due to easy access to Gen Z respondents who actively use Instagram. Data collection through questionnaires is simple, cost-effective, and time efficient. The required information can be collected within the academic schedule using basic analytical tools.

1.6 RELEVANCE TO THE STUDY

Instagram marketing is a major component of modern digital marketing strategies. Understanding its influence on Gen Z purchase decisions is relevant to marketing, consumer behaviour, and financial services, as it helps businesses design effective promotional strategies and predict consumer spending behaviour. The topic is both academically and practically significant.

1.7 IMPORTANCE OF THE STUDY

The importance of this study lies in its relevance to the fast-changing field of digital marketing and consumer behaviour. With the increasing influence of social media platforms, particularly Instagram, businesses are adjusting their marketing strategies to effectively engage younger audiences. Understanding how Instagram affects Gen Z purchase decisions is vital for developing targeted and impactful marketing campaigns. This study is significant for marketers and businesses as it helps identify the most effective Instagram marketing strategies, like influencer collaborations, visual content, and interactive features. By understanding consumer preferences and behaviours, companies can optimize their marketing efforts to increase engagement, build trust, and boost sales. From an academic standpoint, the study contributes to existing literature on social media marketing by focusing on actual purchasing decisions rather than just intentions. It provides insights into the psychological and behavioural aspects of Gen Z consumers, which can inform future research in marketing and consumer studies. Additionally, the study helps understand the role of digital platforms in shaping modern consumer culture. It shows how social media influences perceptions, attitudes, and decision-making processes among young people. The findings can also enable consumers to better recognize marketing tactics and make informed purchasing choices. Overall, this study is a valuable resource for businesses, researchers, and students, offering a deeper insight into the impact of Instagram marketing on the purchasing behaviour of Generation Z customers.

1.8 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY

The study has certain limitations that should be considered while interpreting the results.

The research is based on a relatively small sample size of 87 respondents, which may not represent the entire Generation Z population. The data was collected using an online

questionnaire, which may exclude individuals who are not active online or do not frequently use Instagram.

Additionally, the responses were based on the personal opinions and experiences of the respondents, which may involve some level of bias. Time constraints and limited resources also restricted the scope of the study.

Despite these limitations, the study provides useful insights into how Instagram marketing influences the purchase decisions of Generation Z consumers.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

FEBRIANTI AZIZAH, DIMAS BAGUS WIRANATAKUSUMA, AND ANGGI APRIZAL (2024) employed bibliometrics to examine how Instagram advertisement impacts consumer buying intention through an examination of 50 articles obtained from the Scopus database within the years 2015 to 2024. The research shows that quantitative approaches remain popular (84%) today, with purchase intentions being affected by various factors such as brand strategy, social media environment, and involvement with the product. Some trending topics include time risks, brand recognition, and the behavior of Gen Z consumers. In my view, this study is important in recognizing some gaps that currently exist in existing literature, particularly concerning the need for qualitative studies to explain why Instagram advertisements work.

Ida Bagus Surya Dharma, Hengky, Lim Lee Ching (2024) aimed at examining the effects of influencer marketing on Generation Z consumers' buying intentions in emerging economies. The purpose of this study was to evaluate how variables like credibility, product-influencer relevance, expertise perception, trustworthiness, and peer influence can influence their purchasing behavior. The study used a quantitative approach in analyzing data provided by Generation Z consumers. The researchers used various hypotheses (H1–H5) in analyzing the relationships among these hypotheses. The results of this study indicated that influencer credibility, product-influencer relevance, expertise perception, and trustworthiness have significant influences on Gen Zs' purchase intention. It was further noted that peer influence is relatively insignificant compared to influencers' attributes. The study recommends that marketers in emerging economies consider engaging credible and authentic influencers as they help in building consumer trust, thus influencing their buying intentions.

Elrizal, M. A. & Astuti, R. D. (2024) This paper explores the role of influencer marketing in shaping the purchasing intentions of Generation Z consumers in the setting of emerging economies. It focuses on determining how influencer credibility, product-influencer relevance, perception of expertise, and trustworthiness affect consumer decisions. The quantitative approach was adopted, with the collection of primary data obtained through surveys of Generation Z consumers. The researchers tested five major hypotheses (H1 H5) concerning statistical dependencies between different aspects of influencer marketing and the consumers' final decision to buy. Perceived influencer credibility and product-influencer relevance were

established as factors increasing purchase intentions significantly. Perceived expertise and trustworthiness of an influencer were crucial when convincing Gen Z consumers of the advisability of following brand recommendations. As a matter of interest, peer reviews were determined as less effective in terms of increasing purchase intentions compared to the characteristics of the influencer itself. Consequently, the researchers suggested that for a brand to successfully appeal to Gen Z consumers in emerging markets, it should make sure that its influencer choices involve people whose credibility is high enough. Matching the image of an influencer with the brand's philosophy would be especially important for

Mohammad Ariffa Elrizal, Rifelly Dewi Astuti (2024) This research examined how personalized advertising on Instagram affects consumer brand engagement, brand attachment, perceived quality, and brand loyalty. It focused on these dynamics among Generation Z consumers in Indonesia's digital landscape. The study used a quantitative approach, gathering data from 310 Instagram users aged 16 to 25 who had seen personalized ads. The researchers applied Structural Equation Modelling (SEM) with AMOS 22 software to analyze the relationships between variables. The results showed that perceived personalization positively influenced consumer brand engagement ($\beta=0.903$) and brand attachment ($\beta=0.798$). Both engagement and attachment had significant positive effects on perceived quality and brand loyalty. Notably, consumer brand engagement fully mediated the relationship between personalization and brand loyalty. The authors concluded that personalized advertising is an important strategy for building stronger brand relationships and increasing loyalty among Generation Z consumers on social media. Companies should use tailored content to improve engagement and attachment, which directly enhances perceived quality and loyalty.

Richa Aher and Crystal Angel Lazarus (2024) The main goal of this research was to explore how social media marketing (SMM) affects the buying intentions of Generation Z consumers. The study focused on factors like perceived ease of use, usefulness, social influences, trust, and enjoyment that drive buying behavior. The authors used a quantitative approach and collected primary data through a self-administered questionnaire sent via Google Forms to 81 respondents.

The findings showed a significant link between SMM factors, such as organization reputation, content type, and motivations, and consumer intentions. Seventy-three percent of respondents

said that social media ads influenced their purchases. The study also found that 80% of Gen Z consumers feel loyal to brands that engage with them on these platforms. Furthermore, 61% believe that a brand's online presence affects its credibility directly.

In conclusion, the authors found that social media has changed modern marketing. Generation Z is moving away from traditional information sources and is now turning to digital referrals and interactive content for making informed purchase decisions.

Ekta Lalwani, G. Uday Kumar Meena Rani (2023) conducted a study to explore how Indian start-ups use Instagram for marketing personal care products and its effect on Generation Z consumers. It aimed to find out if Instagram was a good channel for selling personal care items and looked into its impact on consumer buying behavior. The research used a mixed-method approach, gathering both quantitative and qualitative data. It specifically focused on Generation Z users to understand their social media habits and purchasing patterns. The study found that Instagram was the most influential platform for this group among all social media sites. In terms of usage, 36% of respondents were active on Instagram for 30 minutes to 1 hour each day, 18% for 1 to 2 hours, and 16% for less than 30 minutes. Regarding purchase decisions, 51.1% of respondents used social media to help make buying choices, while 48.9% did not. The analysis showed that social media made it easier to access product information and lowered the stress of in-person bargaining.

Isha Lalwani (2023) examined how effective Instagram is as a marketing channel for Indian start-up brands in the personal care sector. The research aimed to analyze how Instagram marketing strategies affected the purchase intentions of Generation Z consumers. A mixed-methods approach was used, with both quantitative and qualitative data collected. The researcher focused on Generation Z participants to assess their social media usage and how digital content drives their buying behavior. The study revealed that Instagram is the most influential platform for this demographic. 36% (72 out of 200) of respondents spent 30 minutes to 1 hour on Instagram daily, while 18% (36 out of 200) spent 1 to 2 hours. 51.1% (102 out of 200) confirmed that social media had a significant impact on their buying choices. The results showed that social media reduces the stress of physical bargaining and offers quick access to product information. The author concluded that Instagram is essential for Indian start-ups to

achieve high customer satisfaction and sales growth. For Generation Z, digital marketing has become the new normal, enabling smooth communication between brands and consumers.

Margareta Nadanyiova and Lucia Sujanska (2023) sought to assess how influencer marketing affects the decision-making process of Generation Z, especially in Slovak and international markets. They used a questionnaire survey and mathematical-statistical methods. The study found that successful campaigns depend on choosing influencers based on credibility, relevance, and engagement rates, not just follower numbers. The findings suggest that effective influencer marketing fosters relationships and increases brand loyalty among Generation Z. This research is particularly important because it highlights that the quality of the relationship between an influencer and their audience is crucial for companies looking to engage with the digitally-savvy Generation Z.

Sameet Rizwan and Dr. Ayesha Qamar (2023) conducted a study to identify changes in consumer behavior and the factors that influence buying intentions through Instagram influencers among Millennials and Generation Z. They used the Theory of Reasoned Action as their framework and surveyed a female population of 400, divided into these two generational groups. The results indicated that factors like parasocial interactions, social media consumer reviews, and the followers-to-following ratio significantly affect purchase intentions for both groups. In contrast, credibility, perceived usefulness, and familiarity were found to be less influential. This research is important as it shows how specific digital interaction metrics, such as follower ratios and peer reviews, have become more important than traditional influencer credibility in the post-COVID-19 era.

Kumar, V., & Sharma, A. (2023). The paper titled "Digital Impact of Instagram Advertisement on Purchase Decisions among Gen Z" was based on quantitative research using surveys to analyze the effectiveness of Instagram ads. The findings suggested that personalized ads, interactive ads, and influencer-based advertisements have a significant effect on the purchase decisions of Gen Z. The paper concludes that authentic visual Instagram ads have more influence than traditional digital ads on Generation Z.

Lim, X. J., Radzol, A. R. M., Cheah, J. H., & Wong, M. W. (2022) The study entitled *The Effect of Instagram on Consumers' Purchase Intention* used a quantitative research design where data were collected using structured questionnaires and analyzed statistically to determine the effect of Instagram on consumers' purchasing intentions. It was found that visual elements, likes, comments, and e-word-of-mouth positively impact consumers' trust and brand perceptions that lead to their higher purchase intention. It has been concluded that Instagram has an important impact on influencing consumers' decisions.

Putri Hedwika Avila Diva Putri Kuncoro, Nurrani Kusumawati (2021) This research study, conducted in Jakarta, Bogor, Depok, Tangerang, and Bekasi (Jabodetabek) as well as in Bandung, Indonesia, attempted to find out what factors affect purchase decisions regarding sleeping goods by Generation Z. In light of an increased incidence of sleep disorders in teenagers, the study explored the influence of customer preferences, value perception (product-related, social-related, and personal-related), sales promotion, and social media marketing on purchase decisions. The study used a quantitative research approach whereby 220 participants were asked to fill in an online questionnaire. Multiple Linear Regression analysis was used to determine the influence of the independent variables on the dependent variable. It turned out that all five independent variables had a strong positive influence on the dependent variable. Particularly, it is important to point out the high considerateness of personal value. As for the consumer preferences, the price range from Rp 50,000 to Rp 100,000 was preferred, as well as natural brown-colored packaging and foreign goods over local ones.

Dhir, A., Talwar, S., Kaur, P., & Malibari, A. (2021) This research paper, titled “Instagram made me buy it”: Generation Z impulse purchasing, used both surveys and interviews as its methodology. It was established that the content on Instagram such as reels, stories, influencers' recommendation, and instant purchasing prompts emotional reactions that encourage impulsive buying. It was concluded from this research that Instagram acts as an impulsive trigger for Generation Z.

Navya Ninan, Joel Chacko Roy, & Dr. Namitha K. Cheriya The main aim of this study was to analyze the effect of social media marketing (SMM) on the buying behavior of Generation Z and the ways through which digital marketing techniques affect brand awareness, brand perception, brand loyalty, and customer-business engagement among Generation Z population. To achieve this, the study adopted a quantitative approach where the study used self-administered questionnaires distributed to 424 participants born after 1994, using independent sample t-test and multiple linear regression analysis for data analysis. Findings revealed that Generation Z significantly favors social media marketing techniques over conventional marketing techniques, whereby all the means in favor of social media were found to be high compared to means that favored conventional marketing, especially customer-business engagement as the most critical factor influencing purchasing intentions. Therefore, the research concluded that Generation Z uses social media marketing as an essential tool in making their decisions.

STEPHANIE L. JACOBSEN AND NORA GANIM BARNES (2020) In their work on the underlying factors that motivate consumers' misconduct in the marketplace, Jacobsen and Barnes (2020) highlight how social media influences consumer behaviour and how its effects contribute to Generation Z's misconduct. According to Jacobsen and Barnes, internal social media pressure affects the ethical code of Gen Z consumers, causing them to exhibit negative behaviour that deviates from common consumption. Although previous studies have identified commercial pressure as an influential factor, this paper represents the first attempt to provide empirical evidence for the significance of internal social pressure due to Instagram use as a motive for misbehavior. From my perspective, this paper is very important for understanding the 'dark side' of social media and the effect of the continuous use of technology on consumers' deviant behavior in the market.

Lou, C., & Yuan, S. (2019) The study titled "The Effect of Instagram Mega-Influencers on Gen Z's Purchase Intention" adopted a quantitative approach through the use of surveys and structural equation modelling to investigate the impact of mega-influencers. The research results indicated that the credibility, expertise, and attractiveness of influencers have a positive effect on purchase intention among Gen Z. On the other hand, too much promotion has a negative effect on trust.

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1. Research Design

Type of Research

This study uses a quantitative research method. Data is collected from respondents using a structured questionnaire to measure the influence of Instagram on user behaviour, preferences, and decision-making.

Nature of the Study

- The study is descriptive and analytical in nature.
- Descriptive because it describes how Instagram influences users in terms of content consumption, purchasing behaviour, and lifestyle choices.
- Analytical because it analyses the factors that influence user engagement, trust, and decision-making based on Instagram content.
- By combining both approaches, the study provides a clear understanding of Instagram's impact and the reasons behind user behaviour.

3.2. Research Objectives / Research Questions

Research Questions:

- How frequently do you use Instagram and what type of content do you engage with the most?
- How does Instagram influence your purchasing decisions choices?
- Which factors (such as influencers, ads, peer content, or trends) affect your behaviour on Instagram?
- What are the major reasons for trusting or not trusting Instagram content?

Objectives of the Study:

1. To identify key Instagram marketing factors (like influencer marketing, Instagram ads, reels/stories, and engagement) that shape Gen Z purchase decisions.

2. To analyse the relationship between influencer marketing and Gen Z purchasing choices.
3. To examine the impact of Instagram advertisements (paid promotions and sponsored posts) on Gen Z buying decisions.
4. To assess the satisfaction level of Gen Z customers.
5. To identify the expectations of Gen Z customers from Instagram.

3.3. Variables of the Study

Independent Variables

- Time spent on Instagram
- Type of content followed (influencers, brands, friends, trends)
- Trust in influencers and advertisements
- Social influence (peer pressure, trends)
- Personal interest and preferences

Dependent Variable

- User behaviour influenced by Instagram (such as purchasing decisions, lifestyle changes, and engagement level)

Control Variables

- Age
- Gender
- Education level
- Occupation

3.4. Data Sources

- **Primary Data:** Collected from respondents through a Google Form questionnaire.
- **Secondary Data:** Collected from research articles, journals, websites, and online sources related to social media and Instagram influence.

3.5. Data Collection Methods, Tools & Techniques

- Primary data was collected through a structured questionnaire using Google Forms.
- The questionnaire was designed to collect information about Instagram usage, behaviour, and influence on respondents.
- Some questions focused on demographic details such as age, gender, and education.
- Other questions focused on usage patterns, trust, influence, and decision-making behaviour.
- The structured format helped in collecting organized data for analysis.
- Google Forms made it easy to collect, store, and analyse responses using tools like Microsoft Excel.

3.6. Target Population / Respondents

- The target population consists of Instagram users.
- Respondents include students, young adults, and working individuals who actively use Instagram.
- Their responses provide insights into how Instagram influences behaviour and decisions.

3.7. Sample Size

- The sample size selected for this study is 90 respondents .

3.8. Sampling Technique

- The study uses convenience sampling technique, where respondents who are easily accessible and willing to participate are selected due to time and resource constraints.

3.9. Measurement of Variables

- Variables are measured using responses collected through the questionnaire.
- Likert scale questions (Strongly Agree to Strongly Disagree) are used to measure opinions on Instagram influence.
- The responses help understand behaviour, trust, and decision-making patterns.

3.10. Data Analysis Techniques

- Percentage Analysis: Used to present data clearly by converting responses into percentages. Helps in understanding trends and comparisons.

- **Weighted Average Mean Method:** Used to analyse Likert scale responses and measure overall perception of Instagram influence.
- **Ranking Method:** Helps identify the most influential factors such as types of content, influencers, or reasons for trust.

3.11. Reliability and Validity

- The questionnaire was designed based on research objectives and literature review.
- It covers key aspects like usage, influence, trust, and behaviour to ensure accuracy and relevance.

3.12. Ethical Considerations

- Participation was voluntary.
- Respondents' information was kept confidential.
- Data was used only for academic purposes.

3.13. Limitations of the Study

- The study is limited to a specific number of respondents.
- Results depend on the honesty of responses.
- Time constraints limited the scope of data collection.

CHAPTER - 4

DATA ANALYSIS & INTERPRETATION

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

The data is collected from respondents through online in structured questionnaires survey. Simple percentage analysis and graphical representations were used to study the trends and opinions.

Table No 4.1 Age of respondents

S. No	Category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	17 - 20	28	31
2	21 - 24	55	61
3	25 - 28	7	7
Total		90	100

Source: Primary data

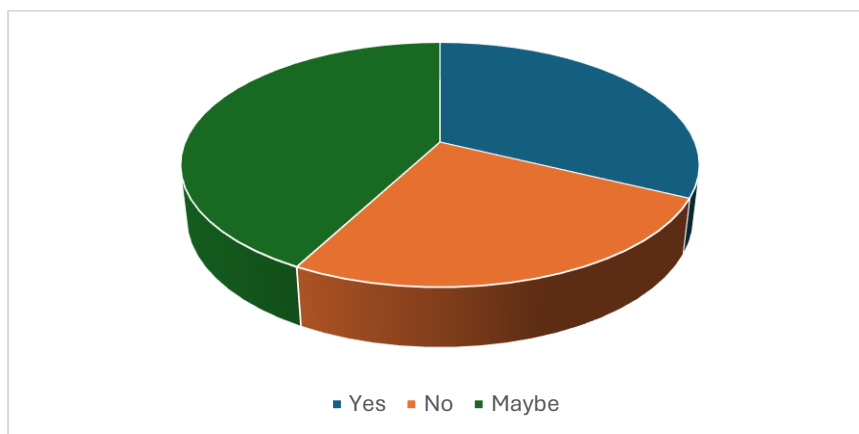


Figure 4.1 age of respondents

Interpretation: The above table and chart represents the age distribution of the respondents. Out of a total of 90 responses, 61.1% of the respondents belong to the age group of 21–24 years, which forms the majority. This is followed by 31.1% of respondents in the age group of 17–20 years. Only 7.8% of the respondents fall under the 25–28 years category, making it the least represented group. From the analysis, it can be concluded that most of the respondents are young adults, particularly in the 21–24 age group, indicating that the study mainly reflects the opinions of this age segment.

Table No. 4.2 Current academics/ professional status

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	UG	47	53
2	PG	17	19
3	Working	25	28
Total		90	100

Source: Primary data

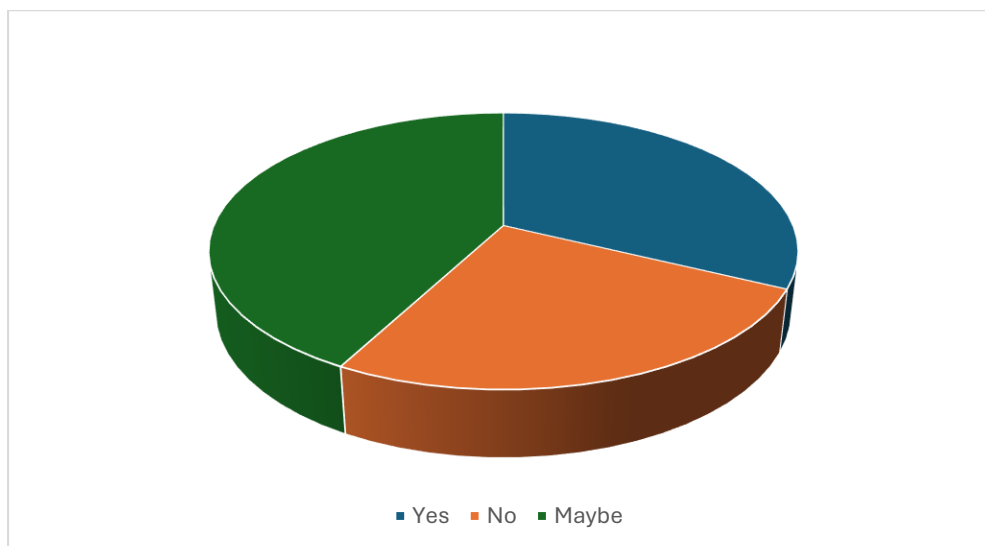


figure No. 4.2 Current academics/ professional status

Interpretation:

The above data shows the academic and professional status of the respondents. Out of 89 responses, 52.8% of the respondents are Undergraduate (UG) students, which constitutes the majority. This is followed by 28.1% of respondents who are working professionals. Meanwhile, 19.1% of the respondents are Postgraduate (PG) students, representing the smallest group. From the analysis, it can be inferred that the majority of the respondents are undergraduate students, suggesting that the study is largely influenced by individuals who are currently pursuing their degree.

Table No. 4.3. Product purchased after seeing on Instagram.

S. No	Category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Yes	64	71
2	No	26	29
Total		90	100

Source: Primary data

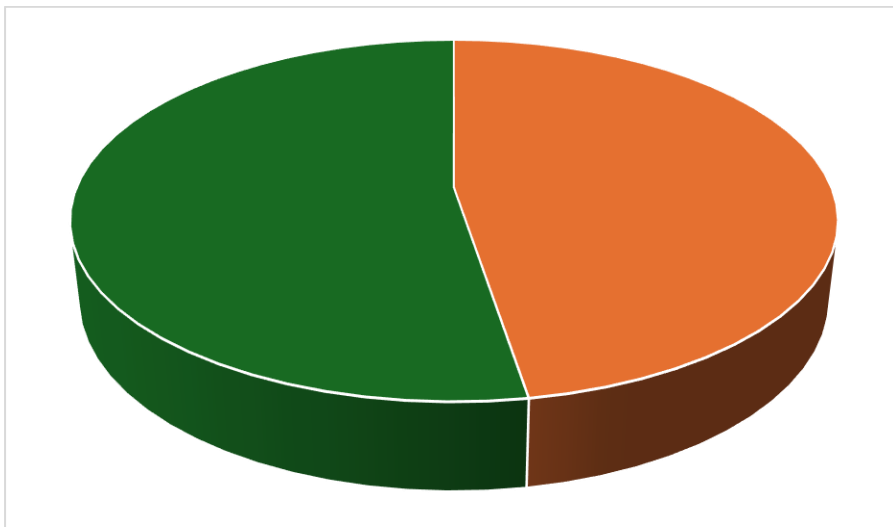


figure No.4.3. Product purchased after seeing on Instagram.

Interpretation:

As seen from the above data, respondents who have bought products after being shown such products on Instagram. From the total number of 90 respondents, 71% of the respondents have bought products after being shown such products on Instagram while the remaining 29% have not made purchases on Instagram.

Table No. 4.4 Influencer recommendation influencing decision to purchase products?

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Yes	29	32
2	No	23	26
3	Maybe	38	42
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

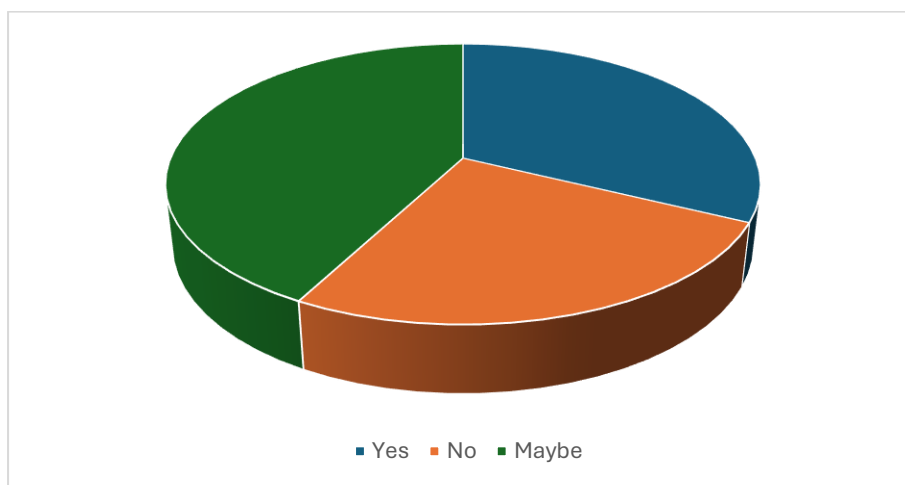


figure No.4.4 Influencer recommendation influencing decision

Interpretation

From the above data, it is apparent whether influencer recommendation affects purchasing decisions. In total, there were 90 respondents where 42.2% answered maybe, 32.2% answered yes, and 25.6% answered no. This implies that influencer recommendation moderately affects purchasing decisions.

Table No. 4.5 Type of Instagram content influences the most to buy a product?

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Instagram Posts	14	16
2	Instagram Ads	19	22
3	Reels	38	43
4	Stories	1	1
5	Brand Posts	16	18
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

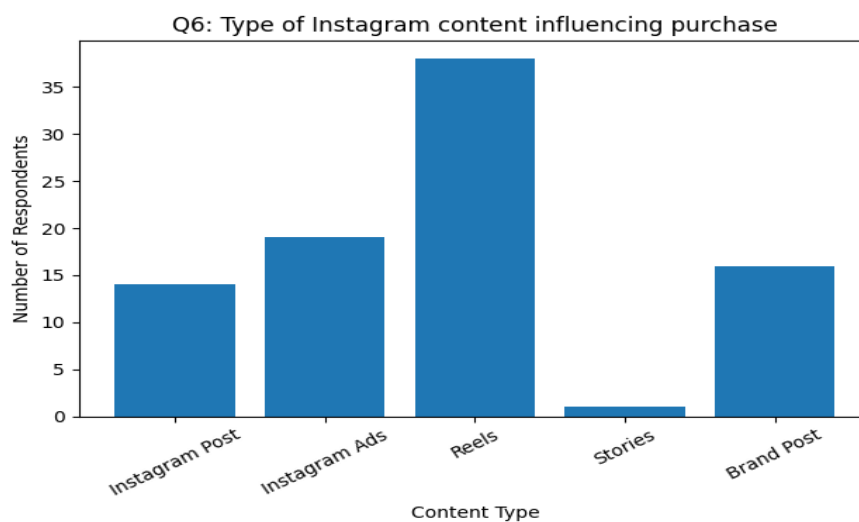


figure No. 4.5 Type of Instagram content influences the most to buy a product

Interpretation:

As can be seen from the above data, the types of content that have the most significant impact on consumers in terms of purchasing items on Instagram are as follows. Out of the total 88 respondents, 43.2% were affected by Instagram reels. This was followed by Instagram ads at 21.6%, brand posts at 18.2%, Instagram posts at 15.9%, and stories at only 1.1%.

Table 4.6 Influence of Trusted Influencers on Purchase Decision

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Yes	29	32
2	No	27	30
3	Maybe	34	37
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

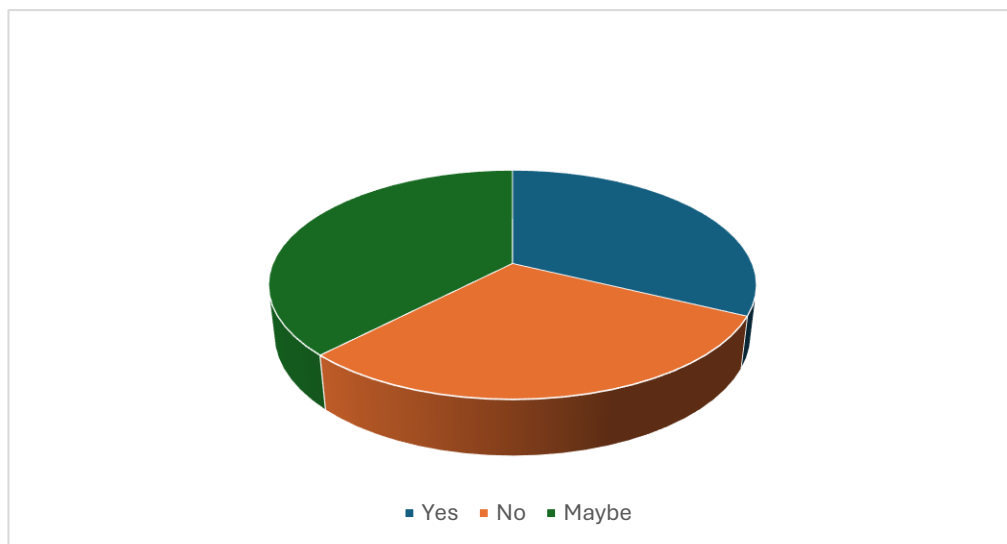


figure No.4.6 Influence of Trusted Influencers on Purchase Decision

Interpretation

The data shows that 37.8% of respondents are unsure (Maybe) about purchasing products recommended by influencers, while 32.2% are willing to buy, and 30% are not influenced.

This indicates that trust in influencers exists but is not strong enough to guarantee purchase decisions, suggesting that Gen Z consumers are cautious and evaluate recommendations before buying.

Table No. 4.7 Impact of Influencer Reviews on purchase decision

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Very High	10	11
2	High	21	23
3	Medium	47	52
4	Low	9	10
5	Very Low	3	3
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

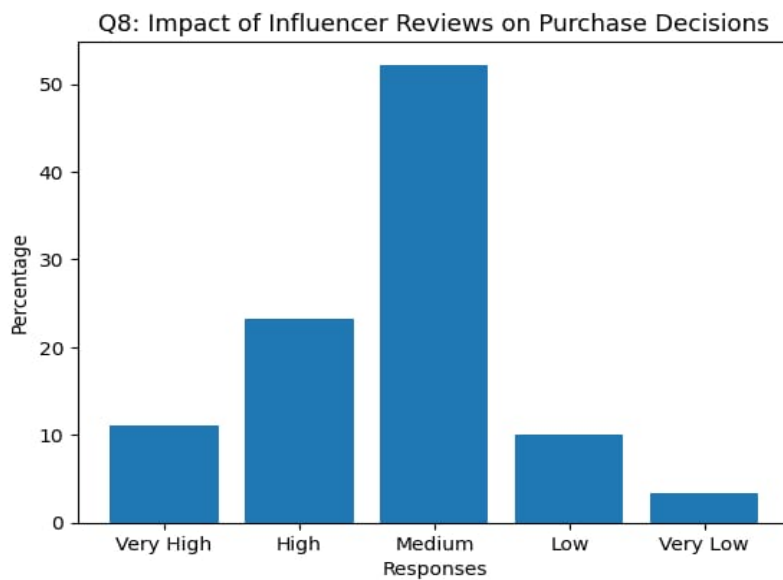


figure No. 4.7 Impact of Influencer Reviews on purchase decision

Interpretation

A majority of respondents (52.2%) stated that influencer reviews have a medium level of impact on their purchase decisions. Only 11.1% reported a very high influence, while smaller percentages fall under low and very low categories.

This implies that influencer reviews play a role, but they are not the sole deciding factor, and consumers likely combine them with other sources like personal research or peer opinions.

Table No. 4.8 Effectiveness of Sponsored Posts

S.NO	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Yes	18	20
2	No	48	53
3	Maybe	24	27
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

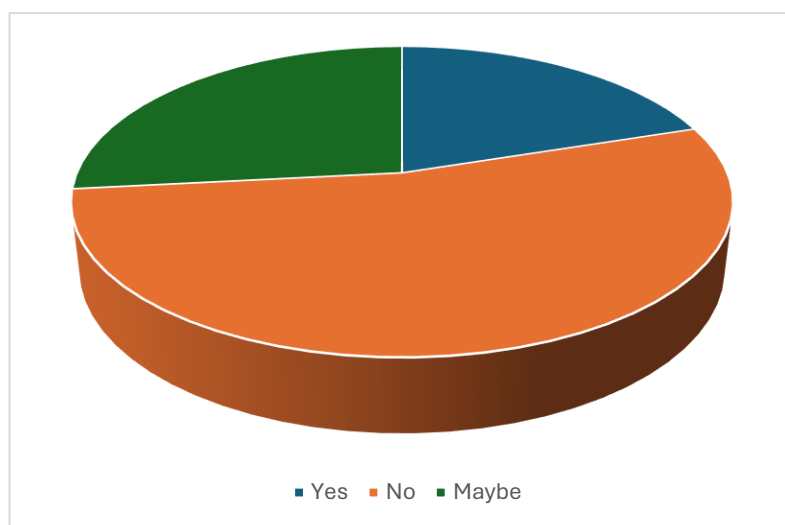


figure No. 4.8 Effectiveness of Sponsored Posts

Interpretation

The results reveal that 53.3% of respondents are not attracted to paid promotions or sponsored posts, while only 20% find them appealing, and 26.7% remain uncertain.

This suggests that Gen Z consumers are skeptical of paid advertising on Instagram and may prefer authentic, organic content over promotional material.

Table No.4.9: Finding Instagram advertisements informative

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Strongly Agree	9	10
2	Agree	27	30
3	Neutral	44	49
4	Disagree	9	10
5	Strongly Disagree	1	1
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

10: Do you find Instagram advertisements informative about products and se

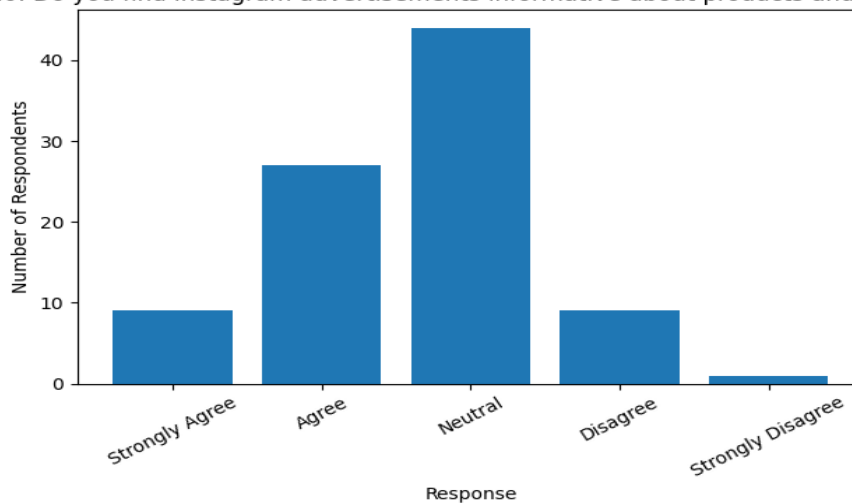


figure No.4.9: Finding Instagram advertisements informative

Interpretation : the Instagram advertisements are had been shown here. The total number of the respondents is 90, out of which 48.9% of the respondents were neutral on the matter, 30% of the respondents agreed, and 10% of the respondents strongly agreed that Instagram advertisements are informative. Nevertheless, 10% disagreed, and 1.1% strongly disagreed.

Table No. 4.11often clicking on Instagram ads or product links

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Very Often	12	13
2	Sometimes	44	49
3	Rarely	26	29
4	Never	8	9
Total		90	100

Source : Primary data

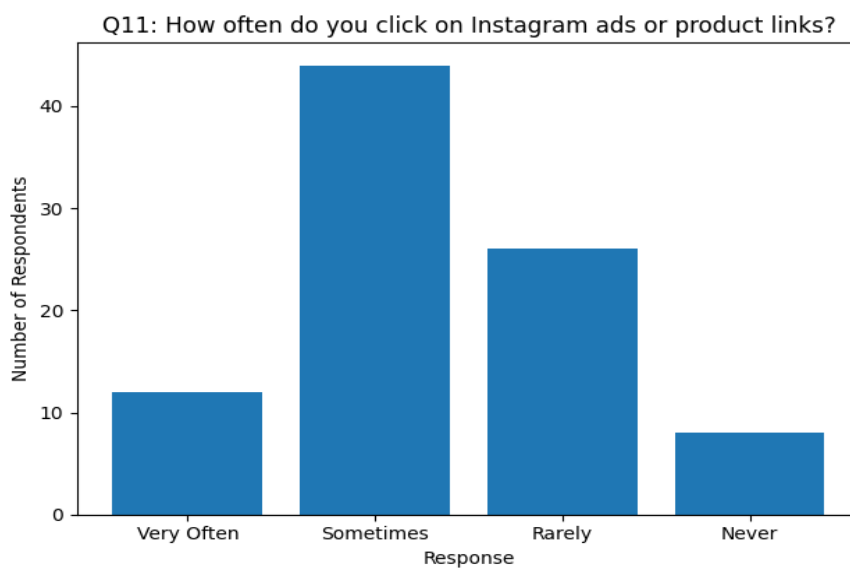


figure No. 4.11often clicking on Instagram ads or product links

Interpretation :

The table presented above provides information about how many times the respondents click on Instagram ads and product links. Out of the 90 respondents, 48.9 percent sometimes click on the ads posted by Instagram, 28.9 percent rarely click on Instagram ads, while 13.3 percent very often click on the ads. On the other hand, 8.9 percent never click on Instagram ads

Table No. 4.12 satisfaction with products purchased

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Very Satisfied	13	14
2	Satisfied	26	29
3	Neutral	43	48
4	Dissatisfied	7	8
5	Very Dissatisfied	1	1
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

Q12: Satisfaction with products purchased through Instagram recommenda

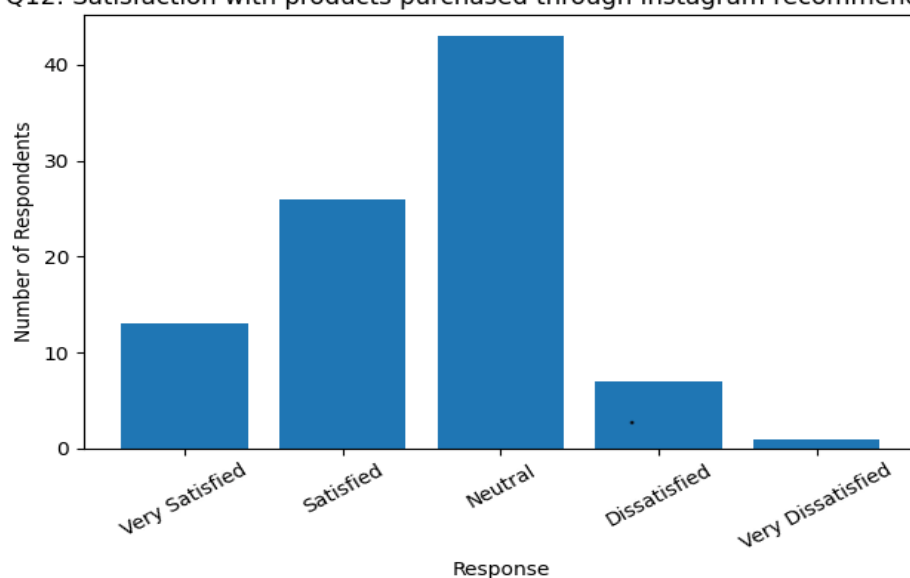


figure No. 4.12 satisfaction with products purchased

Interpretation

As illustrated in the table above, it is clear that the level of satisfaction of respondents for the purchase of products through Instagram recommendations is neutral, with 47.8% respondents having a neutral level of satisfaction, 28.9% respondents being satisfied, and 14.4% respondents being very satisfied. However, 7.8% respondents were dissatisfied, and 1.1% respondents were very dissatisfied with the products.

Table No. 4.13 products promoted on Instagram usually meet my expectations

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Strongly Agree	10	11
2	Agree	30	33
3	Neutral	42	47
4	Disagree	6	7
5	Strongly Disagree	2	2
Total		90	100%

Source of data: primary data

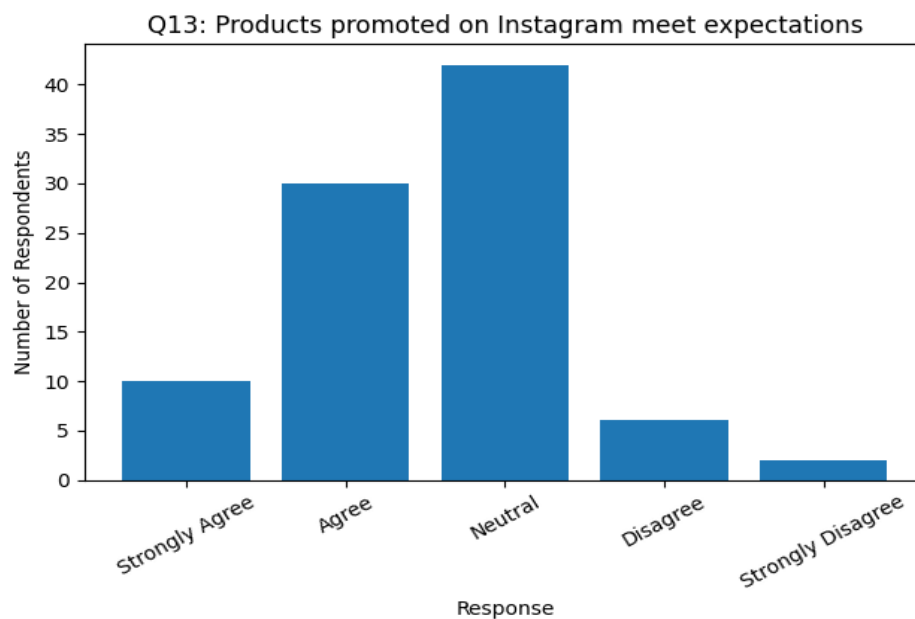


figure No. 4.13 products promoted on Instagram usually meet my expectations

Interpretation:

From the from the above table, one can observe the views of the respondents on whether products advertised via Instagram match their expectations. Out of 90 respondents, it is observed that 46.7% are neutral, while 33.3% agree and 11.1% strongly agree that products advertised via Instagram meet their expectations. On the contrary, 6.7% of them disagree while 2.2% strongly disagree. table, one can observe the views of the respondents on whether products advertised via Instagram match their expectations. Out of 90 respondents, it is observed that 46.7% are neutral, while 33.3% agree and 11.1% strongly agree that products advertised via Instagram meet their expectations. On the contrary, 6.7% of them disagree while 2.2% strongly disagree.

Table No. 4.14 expecting most from brands promoting products on Instagram?

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Honest Review	38	43
2	Attractive Content	15	17
3	Discount / Offer	21	24
4	Clear Product Information	13	15
5	Influencer Recommendation	2	2
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

Q14: What do you expect most from brands promoting products on Instagram

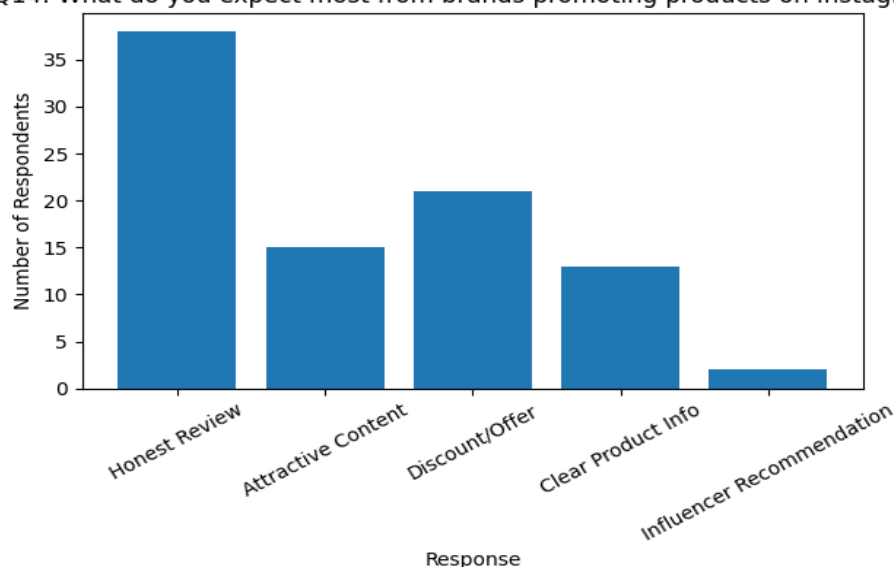


figure No. 4.14 expecting most from brands promoting products on Instagram

Interpretation :

From the above table, one can see the most desirable qualities for the promotion of goods by brands on Instagram. Among the 89 respondents, 42.7% value honest reviews as their first priority, while only 23.6% value discounts and offers. The third most valued quality was attractive content, at 16.9%, followed by informative product information at 14.6%. Finally, only 2.2% value influencers' reviews.

Table No. 4.15 Authenticity of influencers is important when deciding to purchase a product

S. No	category	No. of Respondents	Percentage (%)
1	Strongly Disagree	16	18
2	Disagree	9	10
3	Neutral	35	39
4	Agree	20	22
5	Strongly Agree	10	11
Total		90	100

Source of data: Primary data

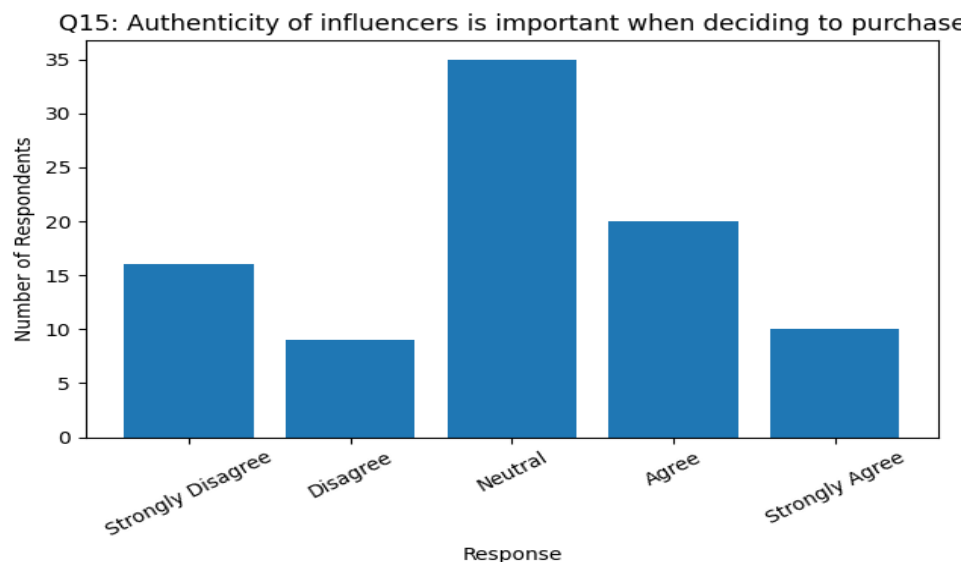


figure No .4.15 Authenticity of influencers is important when deciding to purchase a product

Interpretation:

Table 4 above reflects the level of agreement among the respondents regarding the significance of influencer authenticity as a key factor for making a purchasing decision. Among the total of 90 respondents, 38.9% are neutral, 22.2% agree, and 11.1% strongly agree with the idea that influencer authenticity is significant. On the other hand, 17.8% of the respondents strongly disagree, and 10% disagree.

CHAPTER-5

FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS AND CONCLUSION

FINDINGS.

- A lot of respondents bought products from Instagram. Therefore, Instagram influences their purchasing decisions significantly.
- Recommendations made by influencers play a role in their purchasing decisions to an extent but are not followed blindly.
- Reels are seen to be the most influencing type of Instagram content compared to posts, stories, and ads.
- Instagram ads catch the eye but do not significantly influence purchase decisions.
- The presence of promoted ads does not always translate into the purchase of the product on Instagram.
- Most respondents find Instagram ads informative to a neutral degree, leaving scope for improvement.
- Ads on Instagram are only rarely engaged in by most of the respondents.
- Influencers' recommendation works best when the respondent trusts them
- The degree of influence exerted by the influencer reviews is primarily moderate rather than extremely high.
- The satisfaction level regarding products acquired via Instagram is generally average with many neutral answers.
- There is a considerable proportion of the respondents who claim that products do not always match expectations.
- Authentic reviews are among the top priorities for the audience, thus highlighting their preference for truthfulness.
- The discounts and promotions also constitute an essential motivational component for making purchases.
- Authenticity of the influencers themselves is viewed positively, although there is some indecision on its impact.
- In summary, Instagram marketing proves effective in stimulating interest and raising awareness, but lacks sufficient strength for prompting confident purchasing actions.

SUGGESTION

- Brand should work on delivering genuine reviews so as to instill faith in customers.
- Firms should put more emphasis on producing engaging contents including reels and videos.
- Influencers should be chosen by the basis of credibility and authenticity rather than followers' numbers.
- Ads should become clear enough for people to understand what kind of products they sell.
- It is essential to ensure that products meet the expectations created through advertising.
- Companies should create incentives like good offers and discounts to promote sales.
- It would be wise to increase communication with clients via comments, feedback, and opinion polls.
- Excessive promotion should be avoided; marketers need to produce relevant and engaging content.
- Cooperation with relevant influencers should be considered in order to promote products.
- It is important to pay attention to enhancing the quality of goods produced.
- Providing users with detailed information about products may help decrease hesitation.
- Long-term relations with clients and increased trust should be the key objectives.
- Individualized ads might become more efficient in reaching customers on Instagram.
- Customer feedbacks should be collected and analyzed to make improvements.
- Innovative marketing approaches should be developed to compete effectively on Instagram.

CONCLUSION

The research reveals that Instagram marketing influences the purchasing decisions of Gen Z consumers. A high percentage of the target audience is found to be exposed and influenced by the content on Instagram. It demonstrates that Instagram marketing has an increasingly important role in contemporary marketing strategies.

Nevertheless, the role of Instagram marketing in shaping purchase behavior is not absolute. Though effective in creating awareness, Instagram marketing does not necessarily instill the necessary purchase confidence. Many participants of the survey revealed neutral views about the ads on Instagram and their products and the extent to which their expectations are fulfilled.

Moreover, influencer marketing is also moderately effective in persuading consumers. They tend to trust influencers with whom they can relate. Consumers demand honest and reliable influencer content and do not trust exaggerated marketing techniques. In conclusion, it is clear that Instagram has a great capacity to affect Gen Z buyers in terms of brand persuasion, which depends highly on how well the company succeeds in establishing itself and creating value through trust. This way, brands do not just persuade customers but also establish long-lasting relations with them.

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ANNEXURE

Questionnaire

- 1. NAME**
- 2. AGE**
 - 17 – 20
 - 21 – 24
 - 25 – 28
- 3. What is your current academics / professional status?**
 - UG
 - PG
 - Working
- 4. Have you ever purchased a product after seeing it on Instagram?**
 - Yes
 - No
- 5. Does influencer recommendation influence your decision to purchase product?**
 - Yes
 - No
 - Maybe
- 6. Which type of Instagram content influences you the most to buy a product?**
 - Instagram post
 - Instagram ads
 - Reels
 - Stories
 - Brand post
- 7. Are you more likely to buy a product if it is recommended by an influencer you trust?**
 - Yes
 - No
 - Maybe

8. How much does influencer review affect your purchase decision?

- **Very high**
- **High**
- **Medium**
- **Low**
- **Very low**

9. Does paid promotion or sponsored post on Instagram attract your attention?

- **Yes**
- **No**
- **Maybe**

10. Do you find Instagram advertisements informative about products and services?

- **Strongly agree**
- **Agree**
- **Neutral**
- **Disagree**
- **Strongly disagree**

11. How often do you click on Instagram ads or product links?

- **Very often**
- **Sometimes**
- **Rarely**
- **Never**

12. How satisfied are you with products purchased through Instagram recommendations?

- **Very satisfied**
- **Satisfied**
- **Neutral**
- **Dissatisfied**
- **Very dissatisfied**

13. The product promoted on Instagram usually meet my expectation.

- **Strongly agree**
- **Agree**
- **Neutral**

- **Disagree**
- **Strongly disagree**

14. What do you expect most from brands promoting products on Instagram?

- **Honest review**
- **Attractive content**
- **Discount/offer**
- **Clear product information**
- **Influencers recommendation**

15. Authenticity of influencers is important when deciding to purchase a product.

- **Strongly disagree**
- **Disagree**
- **Neutral**
- **Agree**
- **Strongly agree**